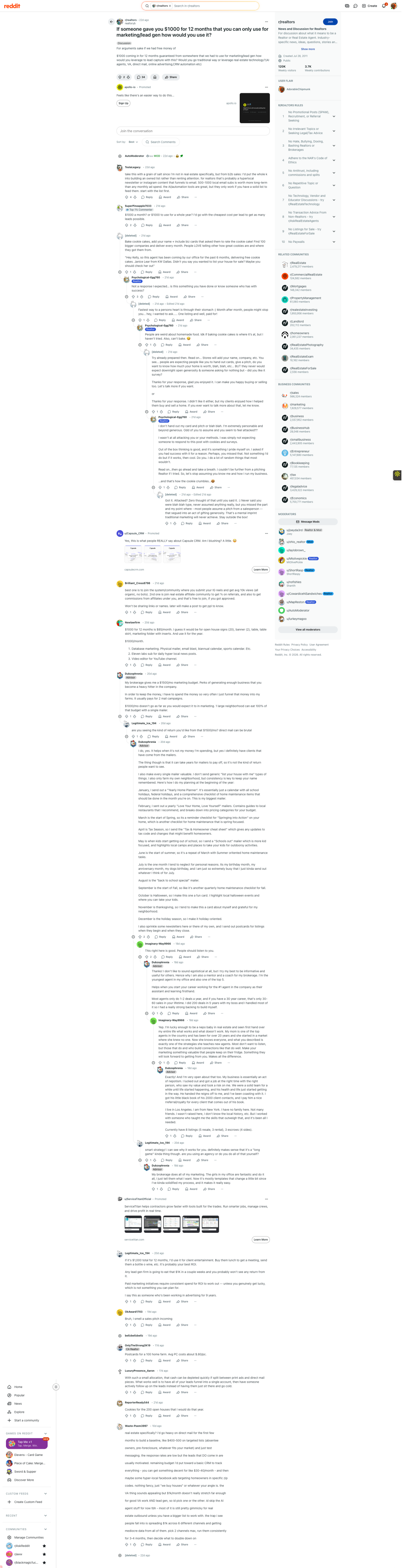

r/realtors · 22d ago
realtoryb

If someone gave you $1000 for 12 months that you can only use for marketing/lead gen how would you use it?

Discussion

For arguments sake if we had free money of

$1000 coming in for 12 months guaranteed from somewhere that we had to use for marketing/lead gen how would you leverage to lead capture with this? Would you go traditional way or leverage real estate technology?(AI agents, VA, direct mail, online advertising,CRM automation etc)

2 · 34 · Share

apollo-io · Promoted

Feels like there's an easier way to do this...

Sign Up · apollo.io

Join the conversation

Sort by: Best · Search Comments

AutoModerator · App MOD · 22d ago

TeslaLegacy · 22d ago

take this with a grain of salt since i'm not in real estate specifically, but from b2b sales: I'd put the whole k into building an owned list rather than renting attention. for realtors that's probably a hyperlocal newsletter or instagram content that funnels to email. 500-1000 local email subs is worth more long-term than any monthly ad spend. the AI/automation tools are great, but they only work if you have a solid list to feed them. start with the list first.

4 · Reply · Award · Share

SuperPineapple7033 · 21d ago
Top 1% Commenter

$1000 a month? or $1000 to use for a whole year? I'd go with the cheapest cost per lead to get as many leads possible.

2 · Reply · Award · Share

[deleted] · 21d ago

Bake cookie cakes, add your name + include biz cards that asked them to rate the cookie cake! Find 100 bigger companies and deliver every month. People LOVE telling other how great cookies are and where they got them from.

"Hey Kelly, so this agent has been coming by our office for the past 6 months, delivering free cookie cakes. Janice Lear from KW Dallas. Didn't you say you wanted to list your house for sale? Maybe you should check her out"

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Psychological-Egg760 · 21d ago
Realtor

Not a response I expected... is this something you have done or know someone who has with success?

3 · Reply · Award · Share

[deleted] · 21d ago · Edited 21d ago

Fastest way to a persons heart is through their stomach :) Month after month, people might stop you... hey, I wanted to ask..... One listing and well, paid for!

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Psychological-Egg760 · 21d ago
Realtor

People are weird about homemade food. Idk if baking cookie cakes is where it's at, but I haven't tried. Also, can't bake. 🥴

1 · Reply · Award · Share

[deleted] · 21d ago

Try already prepared then. Read on... Stores will add your name, company, etc. You see... people are expecting people like you to hand out cards, give a pitch, do you want to know how much your home is worth, blah, blah, etc... BUT they never would expect downright open generosity & someone asking for nothing but - did you like it survey?

Thanks for your response, glad you enjoyed it. I can make you happy buying or selling too. Let's talk more if you want.

or

Thanks for your response. I didn't like it either, but my clients enjoyed how I helped them buy and sell a home. If you ever want to talk more about that, let me know.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Psychological-Egg760 · 21d ago
Realtor

I don't hand out my card and pitch or blah blah. I'm extremely personable and beyond generous. Odd of you to assume and you seem to feel attacked??

I wasn't at all attacking you or your methods. I was simply not expecting someone to respond to this post with cookies and surveys.

Out of the box thinking is good, and it's something I pride myself on. I asked if you had success with it for a reason. Perhaps, you missed that. Not something I'd do but if it works, then cool. Do you. I do a lot of random things that most wouldn't.

Read on...then go ahead and take a breath. I couldn't be further from a pitching Realtor if I tried. So, let's stop assuming you know me and how I run my business.

...and that's how the cookie crumbles...🍪

1 · Reply · Award · Share

[deleted] · 21d ago · Edited 21d ago

Got it. Attacked? Zero thought of that until you said it. :) Never said you were blah blah type, never assumed anything really, but you missed the part and my point where - most people assume a pitch from a salesperson -- that segued into an act of gifting generosity. That's a mental imprint traditional marketing will never achieve. Stay outside the box!

1 · Reply · Award · Share

u/Capsule_CRM · Promoted

Yes, this is what people REALLY say about Capsule CRM. Am I blushing? A little. 😳

capsulecrm.com · Learn More

Brilliant_Cress8798 · 21d ago

best one is to join the system/community where you submit your IG reels and get avg 10k views (all organic, no bots). 2nd one is join real estate affiliate community to get % on referrals, and also to get commissions from affiliates under you, and that's free to join, if you got approved.

Won't be sharing links or names. later will make a post to get ppl to know.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Newlawfirm · 20d ago

$1000 for 12 months is $85/month. I guess it would be for open house signs (20), banner (2), table, table skirt, marketing folder with inserts. And use it for the year.

$1000/month.

1. Database marketing. Physical mailer, email blast, biannual calendar, sports calendar. Etc.
2. Eleven labs sub for daily hyper local news posts.
3. Video editor for YouTube channel.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Dubzophrenia · 20d ago
Advisor

My brokerage gives me a $1500/mo marketing budget. Perks of generating enough business that you become a heavy hitter in the company.

In order to keep the money, I have to spend the money so very often I just funnel that money into my farms. It usually pays for 2 mail campaigns.

$1000/mo doesn't go as far as you would expect it to in marketing. 1 large neighborhood can eat 100% of that budget with a single mailer.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Legitimate_Ice_194 · 20d ago

are you seeing the kind of return you'd like from that $1500/mo? direct mail can be brutal

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Dubzophrenia · 20d ago
Advisor

I do, yes. It helps when it's not *my* money I'm spending, but yes I definitely have clients that have come from the mailers.

The thing though is that it can take years for mailers to pay off, so it's not the kind of return people want to see.

I also make every single mailer valuable. I don't send generic "list your house with me" types of things. I also only farm my own neighborhood, but consistency is key to keep your name remembered. Here's how I do my planning at the beginning of the year:

January, I send out a "Yearly Home Planner". It's essentially just a calendar with all school holidays, federal holidays, and a comprehensive checklist of home maintenance items that should be done in the month you're on. This is my biggest mailer.

February, I sent out a yearly "Love Your Home, Love Yourself" mailers. Contains guides to local restaurants that I recommend, and breaks down into pricing categories for your budget.

March is the start of Spring, so its a reminder checklist for "Springing into Action" on your home, which is another checklist for home maintenance that is spring focused.

April is Tax Season, so I send the "Tax & Homeowner cheat sheet" which gives any updates to tax code and changes that might benefit homeowners.

May is when kids start getting out of school, so I send a "Schools out" mailer which is more kid focused, and highlights local camps and places to take your kids for outdoorsy activities.

June is the start of summer, so it's a repeat of March with Summer oritented home maintenance tasks.

July is the one month I tend to neglect for personal reasons. Its my birthday month, my anniversary month, my dogs birthday, and I am just so extremely busy that I just kinda send out whatever I think of for July.

August is the "back to school special" mailer.

September is the start of Fall, so like it's another quarterly home maintenance checklist for fall.

October is Halloween, so I make this one a fun card. I highlight local halloween events and where you can take your kids.

November is thanksgiving, so I tend to make this a card about myself and grateful for my neighborhood.

December is the holiday season, so I make it holiday-oriented.

I also sprinkle some newsletters here or there of my own, and I send out postcards for listings when they begin and when they close.

2 · Reply · Award · Share

Imaginary-Way9966 · 18d ago

This right here is good. People should listen to you.

2 · Reply · Award · Share

Dubzophrenia · 18d ago
Advisor

Thanks! I don't like to sound egotistical at all, but I try my best to be informative and useful for others. Hence why I am also a mentor and a coach for my brokerage. I'm the youngest agent in my office and also one of the top 5.

Helps when you start your career working for the #1 agent in the company as their assistant and learning firsthand.

Most agents only do 1-2 deals a year, and if you have a 30 year career, that's only 30-60 sales in your lifetime. I did 200 deals in 5 years with my boss and I handled most of it so I had a really strong backing to build myself.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Imaginary-Way9966 · 18d ago

Yep. I'm lucky enough to be a nepo baby in real estate and seen first hand over my entire life what works and what doesn't work. My mom is one of the top agents in the country and has been for over 20 years and she started in a market where she knew no one. Now she knows everyone, and what you described is exactly one of the strategies she teaches new agents. Most don't want to listen, but those that do and who build connections like that do well. Make your marketing something valuable that people keep on their fridge. Something they will look forward to getting from you. Makes all the difference.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Dubzophrenia · 18d ago
Advisor

Exactly! And I'm very open about that too. My business is essentially an act of nepotism. I lucked out and got a job at the right time with the right person, who saw my value and took a risk on me. We were a solid team for a while until life started happening, and his health and life just started getting in the way. He handed the reigns off to me, and I've been coasting with it. I got his little black book of his 2000 client contacts, and I pay him a nice rreferral/royalty for every client that comes out of his book.

I live in Los Angeles. I am from New York. I have no family here. Not many friends. I wasn't raised here, I don't know the local history, etc. But I worked with someone who taught me the skills that outweigh that, and it's been all I needed.

Currently have 8 listings (5 resale, 3 rental), 3 escrows (4 sides).

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Legitimate_Ice_194 · 20d ago

smart strategy! i can see why it works for you. definitely makes sense that it's a "long game" kinda thing though. are you using an agency or do you do all of that yourself?

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Dubzophrenia · 18d ago
Advisor

My brokerage does all of my marketing. The girls in my office are fantastic and do it all, I just tell them what I want. Now it's mostly templates that change a little bit since I've kinda solidified my process, and it makes it really easy.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

u/ServiceTitanOfficial · Promoted

ServiceTitan helps contractors grow faster with tools built for the trades. Run smarter jobs, manage crews, and drive profit in real time.

servicetitan.com · Learn More

Legitimate_Ice_194 · 20d ago

if it's $1,000 total for 12 months, I'd use it for client entertainment. Buy them lunch to get a meeting, send them a bottle o wine, etc. It's probably your best ROI.

Any lead gen firm is going to eat that $1K in a couple weeks and you probably won't see any return from it.

Paid marketing initiatives require consistent spend for ROI to work out -- unless you genuinely get lucky, which is not something you can plan for.

I say this as someone who's been working in advertising for 9 years.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

OkAward1703 · 19d ago

Bruh, I smell a sales pitch incoming

1 · Reply · Award · Share

bellzbellzbellz · 19d ago

OnlyTheStrong2K19 · 17d ago
CA Realtor

Postcards for a 100 home farm. Avg PC costs about $.80/pc.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

LuxuryPresence_Aaron · 17d ago

With such a small allocation, that cash can be depleted quickly if split between print ads and direct mail pieces. What works well is to have all of your leads funnel into a single account, then have someone actively follow up on the leads instead of having them just sit there and go cold.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

ReporterReady544 · 21d ago

Cookies for the 200 open houses that I would do that year.

1 · Reply · Award · Share

Waste-Poem3997 · 10d ago

real estate specifically? i'd go heavy on direct mail for the first few

months to build a baseline, like $400-500 on targeted lists (absentee

owners, pre-foreclosure, whatever fits your market) and just test

messaging. the response rates are low but the leads that DO come in are

usually motivated. remaining budget i'd put toward a basic CRM to track

everything - you can get something decent for like $30-40/month - and then

maybe some hyper-local facebook ads targeting homeowners in specific zip

codes. nothing fancy, just "we buy houses" or whatever your angle is. the

VA thing sounds appealing but $1k/month doesn't really stretch far enough

for good VA work AND lead gen, so id pick one or the other. id skip the AI

agent stuff for now tbh - most of it is still pretty gimmicky for real

estate outbound unless you have a bigger list to work with. the trap i see

people fall into is spreading $1k across 6 different channels and getting

mediocre data from all of them. pick 2 channels max, run them consistently

for 3-4 months, then decide what to double down on

1 · Reply · Award · Share

[deleted] · 22d ago

r/realtors

Join

News and Discussion for Realtors

For discussion about what it means to be a Realtor or Real Estate Agent. Industry-specific news, ideas, questions, stories an...

Show more

Created Jul 28, 2011
Public

120K	3.7K
Weekly visitors	Weekly contributions

USER FLAIR

AdorableChipmunk

R/REALTORS RULES

1 No Promotional Posts (SPAM), Recruitment, or Referral Seeking
2 No Irrelevant Topics or Seeking Legal/Tax Advice
3 No Hate, Bullying, Doxing, Bashing Realtors or Brokerages
4 Adhere to the NAR's Code of Ethics
5 No Antitrust, including commissions and splits
6 No Repetitive Topic or Question
7 No Technology, Vendor and Educator Discussions - try r/RealEstateTechnology
8 No Transaction Advice From Non-Realtors - try r/AskRealEstateAgents
9 No Listings for Sale - try r/RealEstateForSale
10 No Paywalls

RELATED COMMUNITIES

Community	Members
r/RealEstate	2,479,217 members
r/CommercialRealEstate	124,582 members
r/Mortgages	148,342 members
r/PropertyManagement	61,060 members
r/realestateinvesting	1,950,956 members
r/Landlord	202,112 members
r/homeowners	2,951,237 members
r/RealEstatePhotography	34,435 members
r/RealEstateExam	10,162 members
r/RealEstateForSale	2,556 members

BUSINESS COMMUNITIES

Community	Members
r/sales	566,324 members
r/marketing	1,929,577 members
r/business	2,557,952 members
r/BusinessHub	28,048 members
r/smallbusiness	2,443,905 members
r/Entrepreneur	5,147,680 members
r/Bookkeeping	77,135 members
r/tax	457,034 members
r/legaladvice	3,429,322 members
r/Economics	5,700,771 members

MODERATORS

Message Mods

u/joeyda3rd Realtor & Mod
Joey
u/ohio_realtor Mod
u/laylobrown_
u/Mtolivepickle Realtor
MtOlivePickle
u/ShortRasp Realtor
ShortRaspy
u/nofishies
Shantih
u/CowardiceNSandwiches Realtor
u/MapReston Realtor
u/AutoModerator
u/lurkeymagoo

View all moderators

Reddit Rules · Privacy Policy · User Agreement
Your Privacy Choices · Accessibility
Reddit, Inc. © 2026. All rights reserved.